GOV Comment Standard

Anchor-Only Source Pointers to Governed Task Records

Conversely, the existence of a comment or record must not grant authority or prove a claim.

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Abstract

A GOV comment is a compact source-code anchor pointing from a consequential code boundary to a separately governed task record. It is not policy, evidence, a verification result, or an authorization mechanism. The comment identifies the task, the jurisdictional change type, and a resolvable record. The record carries rationale, events, evidence, decisions, and revision history.

The governing rule is: **the code points to the trail; the trail carries the bounded record.** Deleting every GOV comment must not erase the underlying governance history or invalidate replay. Conversely, the existence of a comment or record must not grant authority or prove a claim. This standard defines syntax, placement, resolution, journal semantics, lint behavior, and failure tests. It specifies no implemented linter or tamper-evident log.

Source, Evidence, and Standing

This is an AI-assisted integrated edition derived from one exact author manuscript. The custody manifest is
`work/paper-saturation-v1/evidence/gov-comment-standard-anchor-only/integration-custody-manifest.v0.1.json`,
SHA-256
`0B2B419FF9D25502841FAFD6DFF1EAE93583D4448FE01E92D5E4208F2855F10B`.
The source remains unchanged.

The anchor-only doctrine, allowlist, compact fields, banned claims, deletion safety, filesystem-first journal, event envelope, final-state card, global index, and proposed lint codes are author material. Path security, obligation-status separation, tamper-evidence boundary, lifecycle rules, formal contract, corpus integration, funnel, countertests, and decisions are AI editorial or synthetic candidates until adopted.

No parser, linter, replay engine, journal implementation, repository evaluation, or security test was supplied.

1. Non-Negotiables

1. **Anchors, not law.** A GOV block contains identifiers and tags, never policy prose or rationale.
2. **No result claims.** It must not say that code is verified, secure, safe, correct, fixed, proven, or passing.
3. **No duplicated governance.** Obligation or invariant names may appear only as pointers to definitions in the record.
4. **Deletion safety.** Removing comments must not remove the canonical record or its replayability.
5. **Resolvable pointer.** Every `record` must resolve under a declared repository root and policy.
6. **No path escape.** Resolution must reject traversal, unauthorized absolute paths, unsafe links, and redirects outside the allowed record root.
7. **No self-standing.** A comment, record, event, final state, or linter result cannot authorize or validate itself.
8. **Versioned interpretation.** The comment grammar and record schemas must be versioned.

2. Allowed Placement

GOV anchors are allowed only at declared hazard or authority boundaries, such as authentication and permissions, keys and cryptography, parsing and deserialization, network ingress or egress, financial calculation, safety-critical state transitions, protected data movement, effect authorization, and release or deployment gates.

They should not appear on every function or diff line. Generated code may contain anchors only when generation is stable, the source template and generator are governed, and resolution survives regeneration. The allowlist itself belongs in the repository governance policy, not in each comment.

3. Anchor Grammar

A valid block contains two to five consecutive GOV lines. The minimum is:

```
GOV: v=1 task=<TASK_ID> type=<S|C|I>-<Rep|Ref|Expl|Expa>
GOV: record=<REPO_RELATIVE_PATH_OR_GOV_URI>
```

Optional fields are:

- `obligations=[...]`: names of required invariants or obligations, not assertions that they were satisfied;
- `surface=[...]`: declared boundary tags;
- `risk=[low|med|high]`: triage tag only;

- `subject=<ID>`: exact governed subject when task scope is not sufficient.

Example:

```
// GOV: v=1 task=task_00421 type=I-Rep risk=high
// GOV: obligations=[no_privilege_escalation,no_network_in_parse]
// GOV: record=./governance/tasks/task_00421/
```

Constraints:

- no more than five GOV lines;
- no line longer than 120 characters after decoding;
- no duplicate field;
- one `task`, `type`, and `record` per block;
- no control characters, encoded newlines, or ambiguous Unicode lookalikes;
- no prose or free-form result field;
- no unknown field unless allowed by the selected grammar version.

4. Field Semantics

4.1 Task

`task` is a stable identifier within a declared namespace. Its syntax must exclude path separators and encoding ambiguities. The resolved record's

`task_id` must equal the comment value.

4.2 Type

`type` has the form `<JURISDICTION>-<FUNCTION>`.

Jurisdiction:

- `S`: Specification;
- `C`: Configuration;
- `I`: Implementation.

Epistemic function:

- `Rep`: Repair within declared intent;
- `Ref`: Refinement that tightens constraints without changing declared intent;
- `Expl`: Exploration that adds options without commitment;
- `Expa`: Expansion of capability or surface.

These labels classify the linked work record. They do not prove that the classification is correct. If work crosses categories, the record should declare multiple bounded changes or split the task rather than hide the transition.

4.3 Record

`record` resolves to a canonical task-record root. For a local repository profile:

`./governance/tasks/<TASK_ID>/`

Resolution must normalize separators, reject `..`, reject unauthorized absolute paths, resolve links according to policy, confirm containment under the configured governance root, and verify that the target is the expected record type. A remote URI profile must bind scheme, authority, immutable revision, retrieval policy, and offline behavior. A mutable branch URL is not an immutable record identity.

4.4 Obligations

Names in `obligations=[...]` mean **this task record addresses these named obligations**. They do not mean the obligations passed. Status belongs in evidence and decision records. The original

`invariants=[tests_pass]` example is therefore replaced: `tests_pass` in a source comment can be misread as a result claim even when intended only as a name.

5. Canonical Task Record

The task directory contains at least:

```
meta.json
events.jsonl
final_state.json
```

Optional directories include `prompts/`, `responses_raw/`, `diffs/`, `evidence/`, and `decisions/`. A repository-wide
`governance/index.jsonl` provides discovery but is a projection, not a second source of truth.

5.1 meta.json

`meta.json` binds task identity, schema, creation time, initial authority and scope, declared surfaces, obligations, prohibitions, and related records. It is immutable after creation. Corrections are amendment events; consumers compute current state rather than rewriting the original frame.

5.2 events.jsonl

Each event includes schema, task id, event id, predecessor identity or sequence commitment, timestamp, actor assertion, gate, event type, and data. Append-only is an operational rule, not tamper evidence. If detection of rewriting, deletion, reordering, truncation, or fork is required, the profile needs hash chaining, signed checkpoints, external witnesses, or another declared mechanism.

Standard gates may include `PLAN`, `IMPLEMENT`, `VERIFY`,
and `REVIEW`. Standard event families include lifecycle, prompt handoff, schema

validation, gate transition, patch, evidence, refusal, escalation, amendment, and review decision.

5.3 finalstate.json

`final_state.json` is a rebuildable index card derived from the event stream under a versioned reducer. It records status, declared and bound obligations, scope, evidence index, decision, stop state, and links. It is not the authoritative history and must not contain facts absent from the underlying events and artifacts.

5.4 index.jsonl

The global index points to task records for search. It must be regenerable and may not override a task record. Conflicts between index, final state, and event replay produce a typed conflict, not silent selection.

6. Event and Evidence Semantics

Recommended lifecycle states are `OPEN`, `BLOCKED`, `REFUSED`, `UNDECIDABLE`, `ESCALATED`,
`ACCEPTED`, `REJECTED`,
and `CLOSED`. `COMPLETE` alone is too ambiguous: work can be complete as a process while its proposal is rejected.

An evidence event records what was observed, by which tool and version, against what subject, with what command or method, environment, exit status, artifacts, and claim ceiling. It does not convert a tool result into a universal conclusion.

A review decision binds an authorized actor's disposition to exact evidence and obligations. Actor identifiers and signatures are evidence about identity and custody; authorization is resolved by governing policy.

7. Formal Anchor Contract

Let an anchor be:

$$a = (v, t, y, r, o, s, k),$$

where v is grammar version, t task id, y typed jurisdiction/function, r record locator, o obligation names, s surface tags, and k risk tag.

Resolution is valid only when:

$$
\begin{aligned}
&Valid(a) = Parse_v(a) \\
&\wedge Contained(Resolve(r)) \\
&\wedge TaskMatch(t, r) \\
&\wedge SchemaValid(r) \\
&\wedge PolicyAllows(a, r)
\end{aligned}
\quad .
$$

Validity means the anchor is structurally acceptable and resolvable. It does not mean the linked task succeeded or the code is correct.

Deletion safety requires:

$$
Replay(Records) = Replay(Records \mid CommentsRemoved).
$$

Discovery may become worse after deletion; governance identity and replay must not.

8. Lint Contract

A reference linter should tokenize comment syntax using the host language or a declared generic profile. One broad regex is insufficient for nested block comments, strings containing `GOV:`, generated sources, line continuations, encodings, and mixed comment delimiters.

Core violations include:

- `GOV_BAD_VERSION`;
- `GOV_BLOCK_TOO_LONG`;
- `GOV_LINE_TOO_LONG`;
- `GOV_MISSING_TASK`;
- `GOV_MISSING_TYPE`;
- `GOV_MISSING_RECORD`;
- `GOV_DUPLICATE_FIELD`;
- `GOV_UNKNOWN_FIELD`;
- `GOV_BAD_TASK_ID`;
- `GOV_BAD_TYPE`;
- `GOV_BANNED_CLAIM`;
- `GOV_PROSE_DETECTED`;
- `GOV_RECORD_UNRESOLVED`;
- `GOV_RECORD_OUTSIDE_ROOT`;
- `GOV_TASK_MISMATCH`;
- `GOV_RECORD_SCHEMA_INVALID`;
- `GOV_OBLIGATION_UNKNOWN`.

Syntax errors are distinct from resolution failures. A repository may lint syntax offline and perform full resolution in a separate governed verification step.

9. Security and Privacy Boundaries

GOV comments are public to everyone who can read the source. They must not contain secrets, private prompts, internal locations that expose protected infrastructure, personal data, or vulnerability details unsuitable for the repository. The record may require access control, redaction, retention, and disclosure policy.

A resolvable pointer can itself be dangerous if resolution follows attacker-controlled links or triggers network access. Linters should default to non-effectful local resolution and require explicit authority for remote retrieval.

10. Primitives, Invariants, Dimensions, and Adjacencies

Primitives: anchor block, grammar version, task id, type, record locator, obligation name, surface tag, risk tag, governance root, task record, event, evidence item, decision, reducer, index, amendment, and conflict.

Invariants: comments remain pointers; result claims stay outside comments; record resolution is contained; task identity agrees across surfaces; histories are not silently rewritten; projections are rebuildable; evidence remains claim-scoped; deletion does not erase governance; and no artifact self-authorizes.

Dimensions: language syntax, repository layout, local versus remote records, path policy, schema evolution, tamper evidence, signature policy, privacy, retention, hazard allowlist, obligation vocabulary, event granularity, and replay cost.

Adjacencies: Reasoning by Way of Receipts supplies bounded epistemic records; Agentic Interface Surfaces explains recognition and refusal at effect boundaries; Work Custody locates responsibility across handoffs; GMB can index anchors and records. These are interfaces, not identity mergers.

11. GMB and Universal GSM Projection

The Governed Meaning Base can represent anchors, code subjects, task records, actors, obligations, evidence, decisions, conflicts, and revisions with relations such as `ANCHORS_TO`,
`GOVERNS_SUBJECT`, `DECLARES_OBLIGATION`, `EVIDENCED_BY`, `DECIDED_BY`, `CONFLICTS_WITH`,
and `SUPERSEDES`. GMB is a retrieval and meaning substrate, not the authority source or canonical filesystem record merely because it indexes the material.

12. Realization Funnel

$$
\begin{aligned}
&\mathit{Possibility}\\
&\rightarrow \mathit{Specification}\\
&\rightarrow CM_1\\
&\rightarrow CM_2\\
&\rightarrow IC\\
&\rightarrow IR\\
&\rightarrow \mathit{Evidence}\\
&\rightarrow \mathit{Revision}
\end{aligned}
$$

- **Possibility:** enumerate anchor grammars, record stores, languages, boundary classes, attacks, and operational outcomes.
- **Specification:** define syntax, placement, resolution, records, events, evidence, decisions, replay, and errors.
- **CM1:** retain admissible profiles across languages and repository layouts.
- **CM2:** prefer profiles under legibility, security, portability, privacy, tooling, and maintenance criteria.
- **IC:** select an Instance Constitution or Instance Configuration for one repository.
- **IR:** build its Instance Realization or Implementation Realization as parsers, linters, resolvers, reducers, and replay tools.
- **Evidence:** run grammar, path, security, mutation, replay, false-positive, and repository-scale tests.
- **Revision:** evolve schemas and vocabularies without breaking or silently reinterpreting prior anchors.

Any parser Intermediate Representation remains a separate sense of `IR` from the realization-stage term.

Governed Source-Anchor Profile

Across the completed P1 corpus, the GOV Comment Standard is best classified as the **source-anchor profile that connects a consequential code location to a governed task record without placing law, evidence, or standing in the comment itself**. It is not a second receipt system, an authorization primitive, a general annotation language, or proof that the linked code is governed correctly.

- **Adjacent work:** *Reasoning by Way of Receipts*
  Supplies: Durable transition, evidence, refusal, and revision records.
  GOV boundary: A GOV comment points toward a record; it is not itself the receipt or its verification.

- **Adjacent work:** *Agentic Interface Surfaces*
  Supplies: Effect, evidence, and recognition surfaces.

GOV boundary: GOV anchors expose task context at selected source boundaries without becoming the gate.

- **Adjacent work:** *A Formal Theory of Work Custody*
  Supplies: Custodian, handoff, acceptance, return, and terminal-disposition semantics.
  GOV boundary: A record may evidence custody changes; a comment cannot assign custody by assertion.
- **Adjacent work:** *Meta-Binding as Operational Invariant*
  Supplies: Binding preservation across transformations and carriers.
  GOV boundary: GOV resolution must preserve task and subject identity across source, record, and projection.
- **Adjacent work:** *Constitutional Binding Theory: Governed Anchor Resolution as a Universal Pattern in Semantic Systems*
  Supplies: General anchor-resolution and binding pattern.
  GOV boundary: GOV is one concrete source-code profile of that broader pattern.

A resolved anchor instance should bind:

$$G = (source_revision, location, grammar, task, subject, \\ record_root, resolution_policy, obligations, \\ record_identity, status, evidence, standing)$$

The source revision and location identify where the pointer was observed. The task and subject identify what it concerns. The record identity identifies the separately governed history. Resolution proves only that the pointer is structurally valid and reaches the expected bounded record under the named policy. Record status, obligation satisfaction, authorization, and code quality require separate evidence and decisions.

The anchor must survive source movement through an explicit rebinding or successor relation rather than silent path guessing. Generated-code anchors require lineage to their generator and template. If comments disappear, the governance history must remain reconstructable; if the record disappears, the comment must fail closed as an unresolved pointer rather than retain stale implied standing.

The universal GSM can type
`ANCHORS_SOURCE_LOCATION`, `RESOLVES_TO_TASK_RECORD`,
`BINDS_EXACT_SUBJECT`, `DECLARES_OBLIGATION_NAME`, `REBOUND_AFTER_SOURCE_MOVE`,
`GENERATED_FROM_GOVERNED_TEMPLATE`, `UNRESOLVED_UNDER_POLICY`, `EVIDENCED_BY_RECORD`,
`DOES_NOT_GRANT_AUTHORITY`,
and
`SUPERSEDED_BY_ANCHOR`. These relations keep discovery, record identity, evidence, and authority separate.

This integration establishes four editorial commitments: classify GOV as a governed source-anchor profile; adopt the resolved-anchor envelope; require explicit rebinding and generator lineage; and preserve the rule that anchor resolution never implies authorization, verification, or obligation satisfaction.

Anchor Discovery Versus Operational Use

The fixed-seed comparison with MCIR topology, the Optional Coordinator, the SMT retrieval microcase, and Meta-Binding exposes a complete source-anchor use chain:

$$A = (source_anchor, resolution, record, admission, custody, \\ operational_use, effect, evidence)$$

The anchor resolves from an exact source location through a named policy to a task or subject record. SMT-style node, edge, and path judgments can test whether related records may participate in a retrieval path. Neither resolution nor path admission proves that the source, agent, compiler, or runtime used the record's constraints.

Meta-Binding supplies that later question: did the represented constraint alter behavior under controlled perturbation? A GOV anchor can improve discoverability and custody while remaining entirely ceremonial. The record must bind the mechanism or decision path by which an obligation becomes load-bearing, and its effect must be separately observed.

MCIR topology governs the AST location, canonical subject, and receipt lineage needed to keep the anchor stable across revision. The Optional Coordinator remains a `QUALIFIED_INTERFACE`: anchors may route to coordination tasks or evidence, but their presence cannot establish coordinator necessity, substitution, or decentralization.

The universal GSM can type
`RESOLVES_SOURCE_ANCHOR`, `ADMITS_ANCHOR_PATH`,
`CUSTODIES_ANCHORED_TASK`, `USES_ANCHORED_CONSTRAINT_OPERATIONALLY`,
`LEAVES_ANCHOR_CEREMONIAL`, `OBSERVES_ANCHORED_EFFECT`,
and
`DOES_NOT_PROVE_COORDINATOR_OPTIONALITY`.

This randomized review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the anchor-use chain; separate resolution and retrieval admission from operational constraint use; require load-bearing and effect evidence for consequential anchors; and retain coordinator relations only as bounded task-navigation interfaces.

One Confirmed Downstream Use and a Deliberately Narrow Profile

The complete frozen P3 field contains one confirmed downstream use beyond this paper: *Representational Topology in MCIR* uses the GOV source-anchor profile to connect an exact source location, canonical task or subject object, and separately governed receipt graph. That use validates a concrete interface question, not implementation or adoption:

$$\begin{aligned} G^* = (&source_revision, AST_location, anchor,\\ &canonical_subject, task_record, receipt_lineage,.\\ &correspondence, rebind, evidence, remainder) \end{aligned}$$

The downstream use exposes an obligation that is only implicit in the current standard. Source location, task record, and receipt history may inhabit different graphs with different canonicalization, access, mutation, and privacy rules. Rebinding must therefore identify the source and target graph profiles, preserved identities, authorized loss, and unresolved remainder. A path or hash reused across graphs does not establish correspondence.

No other material downstream dependency was confirmed by the bounded lexical and semantic screen. That absence should be preserved rather than filled by analogy: GOV remains a narrow source-anchor profile awaiting a parser, linter, conformance suite, repository trial, and evidence that agents or developers actually use anchored obligations in decisions.

The universal GSM can type
`ANCHORS_AST_LOCATION`, `CORRESPONDS_TO_CANONICAL_SUBJECT`, `LINKS_SEPARATE_RECEIPT_GRAPH`, `REBINDS_ACROSS_GRAPH_PROFILE`, `LEAVES_CROSS_GRAPH_REMAINDER`, and `HAS_NO_CONFIRMED_WIDER_DEPENDENCY`.

This reverse-dependency review establishes four editorial commitments: add an explicit cross-graph correspondence contract; bind rebinding to source and target profiles; retain the single confirmed downstream use without claiming adoption; and preserve the profile's narrow standing until implementation and use evidence exist.

13. Counterevidence and Failure Tests

The standard must narrow, revise, or fail if: (1) a two-line canonical block is rejected despite the stated minimum; (2) a six-line block passes; (3) duplicate fields pass; (4) unknown fields silently pass; (5) banned result claims pass; (6) obligation names are interpreted as satisfied results; (7) strings containing `GOV:` are parsed as comments; (8) nested block comments confuse boundaries; (9) encoded newline injection creates hidden fields; (10) Unicode lookalikes bypass tokens; (11) task ids contain path separators; (12)

`..` escapes the root; (13) absolute paths bypass policy; (14) symlinks escape containment; (15) case folding aliases different records; (16) percent encoding changes resolution; (17) remote redirects leave the allowed authority; (18) mutable URLs change history; (19) missing records pass; (20) task id mismatches pass; (21) invalid schemas pass; (22) a comment grants authority; (23) a comment is treated as verification evidence; (24) deleting comments deletes the journal; (25) deleting comments makes replay impossible; (26) final state contains facts absent from events; (27) an index overrides a task record; (28) truncation is undetected when tamper evidence is claimed; (29) event reordering is undetected when order integrity is claimed; (30) append-only is treated as cryptographic protection; (31) actor id is treated as authorization; (32) a signature self-authorizes; (33) stale evidence remains current; (34) conflict becomes pass; (35) `COMPLETE` hides rejection; (36) amendment rewrites `meta.json`; (37) reducer version is omitted; (38) replay changes with locale or platform; (39) remote lint performs unauthorized network effects; (40) comments leak secrets; (41) records leak protected prompts; (42) generated code drifts from templates; (43) anchors saturate ordinary code; (44) the hazard allowlist omits a consequential boundary; (45) lint false positives cause teams to disable the system; (46) GMB indexing becomes the authority sink; (47) source and AI additions are mixed; or (48) publication occurs without a reference parser and conformance suite.

A Source Anchor Points to Governance; It Does Not Perform It

Public orientation

A GOV comment is a compact pointer from a consequential code boundary to a separately governed task record. The code points to the trail; the trail carries rationale, events, evidence, decisions, and revisions. Deleting comments must not erase governance history, and possessing a comment or record must not authorize, verify, or prove anything.

Adversarial tests

1. **Anchor-authority attack.** A GOV marker is read as approval, security review, conformance, or permission to execute.
2. **Stale-pointer attack.** The code moves or changes while the anchor resolves to an obsolete task, artifact, version, scope, or final state.
3. **Path-escape attack.** Traversal, symlink, redirect, case, encoding, network, or repository-root confusion resolves outside the admitted record domain.
4. **Record-substitution attack.** A valid task identifier points to rewritten metadata, events, evidence, or final state without detectable lineage.
5. **Index-oracle attack.** A derived global index becomes the authoritative state and silently diverges from immutable events.
6. **Generated-code attack.** Regeneration deletes, duplicates, relocates, or

fabricates anchors while downstream tooling retains false confidence.

7. **Privacy-leak attack.** Task IDs, paths, obligations, status, actors, or evidence links expose sensitive security and organizational information through source.
8. **Lint-conformance attack.** Parser and resolver success is promoted into evidence that obligations were fulfilled or governance was effective.

Claim and evidence ceiling

The paper specifies an anchor grammar, task-record profile, journal semantics, security boundaries, and lint contract. It does not establish tamper evidence, immutability, authority, obligation satisfaction, security, privacy, replay, complete anchor coverage, or an implemented parser, linter, resolver, journal, or index. One confirmed downstream use does not establish general adoption or benefit.

Validation requires language-aware parsers, hostile path fixtures, repository and platform normalization tests, immutable event and predecessor rules, generated-code cases, privacy profiles, stale-anchor detection, deletion-safety replay, and current comparison with code annotation and traceability systems. None was performed in this pass.

Reader-facing consequence

The standard succeeds when a reviewer can move from the exact code boundary to the exact governed history and back, while never mistaking a pointer, linter result, or final-state card for the decision or evidence itself.

Conclusion

GOV comments should remain small enough to ignore during ordinary reading and precise enough to recover the governed trail when needed. Their power comes from separation: code carries the pointer; the task record carries reasons, evidence, and decisions; governing policy determines authority.

The standard succeeds when removing the pointers cannot erase history, adding a pointer cannot manufacture standing, and resolution exposes an exact, bounded, replayable record without opening a new attack surface.

Reference and Verification Note

The exact internal comparison set inspected for this candidate includes *Reasoning by Way of Receipts*, *Agentic Interface Surfaces*, and *A Formal Theory of Work Custody*. No external literature was consulted. Further evidentiary strengthening requires prior-art review and a separately authorized reference parser, conformance suite, path-security suite, replay test, and repository-scale usability evaluation.

Realization Scope and Evidence Boundary

This successor makes the paper's stage boundary explicit. It narrows claims rather than manufacturing missing evidence: a stage named as context is not thereby claimed as implemented, validated, or complete.

- **Possibility Space.** Existing source passages use this stage only as bounded context or an obligation. The paper does not claim an independently validated contribution at this stage.

Corpus-Wide Reference Positioning

This paper argues that a GOV comment is a compact source-code anchor pointing from a consequential code boundary to a separately governed task record. Its nearest external comparison fields are software, provenance, governance. The sources in [E1], [E2], [E3], [E4], [E5], [E6], [E7] are cited as predecessor literature, adjacent standards, or counterpressure - not as evidence that they caused the Ableman framework or that they validate its novel claims. The comparison isolates where established work already supplies provenance, formal assurance, institutional constraint, empirical method, or engineering practice, and where this paper adds a distinct claim about admissibility, authority, semantic custody, or governed realization.

Within the Ableman corpus, the highest-priority current cross-links are [A1], [A2], [A3], [A4], [A5], [A6], [A7]. These are links among separately custodied works, not silent identity mergers. Their role is to expose mutual dependencies, terminology collisions, and places where a reader should traverse the corpus before treating this paper as self-sufficient.

Reference-pass counterevidence and limit search

The pass applied the following pressure tests: Modularity, secure-development practice, and reproducibility reduce classes of failure but do not guarantee architectural coherence or user sovereignty. A complete provenance graph can faithfully record a false or unauthorized process; provenance is evidence about lineage, not automatic truth or legitimacy. A written constitution can legitimate domination as easily as constrain it unless amendment, participation, enforcement, and appeal remain effective in practice. These limits are not generic disclaimers: they identify the assumptions that a later empirical, formal, or implementation review must try to break.

Reference-pass influence and novelty boundary

No newly added external source is asserted to be a documented authorial influence unless the predecessor source already said so. `Predecessor` means earlier relevant work;

`adjacent` means a useful comparison; `standard` means an interoperability or

assurance baseline; and `counterevidence` marks work that narrows or pressures a claim. Novelty therefore remains a reviewable, claim-level question rather than an inference from a low similarity score or an absent citation.

References

External scholarship, standards, and prior art

[**E1**] David L. Parnas. "On the Criteria To Be Used in Decomposing Systems into Modules." *Communications of the ACM* 15(12), 1972, pp. 1053-1058. DOI: 10.1145/361598.361623. https://doi.org/10.1145/361598.361623 **Relationship:** Foundational modularity treatment used to compare information hiding with explicit semantic and governance interfaces.

[**E2**] Ward Cunningham. "The WyCash Portfolio Management System." *OOPSLA '92 Experience Report*, 1992. DOI: 10.1145/157709.157715. https://doi.org/10.1145/157709.157715 **Relationship:** Original technical-debt metaphor used to distinguish implementation debt from semantic debt.

[**E3**] Karen Scarfone, Murugiah Souppaya, and Donna Dodson. *Secure Software Development Framework (SSDF) Version 1.1.* NIST SP 800-218, 2022. DOI: 10.6028/NIST.SP.800-218. https://doi.org/10.6028/NIST.SP.800-218 **Relationship:** Adjacent secure-development framework for preparation, protection, production, and vulnerability response.

[**E4**] Reproducible Builds Project. *Formal Definition of Reproducible Builds.* reproducible-builds.org source **Relationship:** Adjacent reproducibility practice; byte reproduction is compared with, but not equated to, semantic or constitutional continuity.

[**E5**] W3C. *PROV-O: The PROV Ontology.* W3C Recommendation, 30 April 2013. https://www.w3.org/TR/prov-o/ **Relationship:** Adjacent provenance standard; it models entities, activities, and agents, but does not by itself establish the paper's stronger authority or standing claims.

[**E6**] Santiago Torres-Arias et al. "in-toto: Providing Farm-to-Table Guarantees for Bits and Bytes." *28th USENIX Security Symposium*, 2019, pp. 1393-1410. usenix.org source **Relationship:** Predecessor supply-chain lineage system used for comparison; no influence claim is made unless the source head already documents one.

[**E7**] OpenSSF. *Supply-chain Levels for Software Artifacts (SLSA), Version 1.2.* 2026. https://slsa.dev/spec/v1.2/ **Relationship:** Adjacent software-supply-chain assurance standard, especially relevant to provenance and verification boundaries.

Ableman corpus

[**A1**] Adam Ableman. *Sovereign Software.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity

AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-24C6159B98023A9C;
source SHA-256
6AAFE79E438B980B75D1910A897F7BA716A10CF1187B68CB1F71405F36725A18.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A2**] Adam Ableman. *Constitutional Software Analysis (CSoftA): A Governance-Based Classification Method for Software Systems.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity PAPER.PUB.20472196;
source SHA-256
3670B28B7C1AF5467BE4002C47B5F964F8FAF6F257125C2F84CE06904E4FD0DE.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A3**] Adam Ableman. *Semantic Fragmentation and Constitutional Structure in Software Systems.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-B307F65B51C503DE;
source SHA-256
9D2A9D79DE8BC3F2F8ABECA073E4D3607F7623F4368E63F8036081E39B4C75C3.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A4**] Adam Ableman. *Governed Coding and Debugging.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity PAPER.PUB.18115533;
source SHA-256
2469EDA96DBC1E207855A9AD27314A7FAB59FA35E6EFEF9288C30F949376BF16.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A5**] Adam Ableman. *Constitutional Operating Systems.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
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Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

Editorial source notes retained from predecessor

The entries below are corpus-internal comparison and dependency sources. Their inclusion does not establish external validation of this paper's empirical, safety, novelty, or performance claims.

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Corpus source and companion formats: https://github.com/AblemanMosaic/ableman-corpus
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DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.23847768